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ARTICLE

This Is Not Christianity: Methodists Endorse Gender Surgeries For Children

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BY PNW STAFF MARCH 31, 2026

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The crisis now gripping the United Methodist Church is no longer a matter of quiet theological drift--it is an open, accelerating rupture with historic Christianity.

In a stunning public statement, Bishop Julius C. Trimble and the denomination's General Board of Church and Society have not merely expressed sympathy toward those experiencing gender confusion. They have gone far beyond pastoral care into outright advocacy for irreversible medical interventions on children--procedures Scripture never contemplates and Christian tradition has consistently resisted when it comes to harming the body.

For many believers, this is not just another policy disagreement. It feels like betrayal. A church that once preached repentance and redemption now lobbies Congress to expand access to what it calls "gender-affirming care," including puberty blockers and surgical alterations for minors. That shift raises a sobering question: At what point does a church cease to reflect Christ and begin to mirror the culture it was meant to challenge?

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First, this position directly collides with the biblical view of the human body. Christianity has always taught that the body is not a disposable shell but a created gift. From the opening chapters of Genesis to the writings of the Apostle Paul, the human person is presented as an

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He issued one of His most severe warnings: "Whoever causes one of these little ones who believe in me to sin, it would be better for him to have a great millstone fastened around his neck and to be drowned in the depth of the sea." This is not metaphorical softness--it is divine severity. Children are to be protected, not experimented upon. Encouraging irreversible procedures before a child has reached full maturity raises profound moral concerns about consent, long-term harm, and spiritual responsibility.

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Third, the church's stance reflects a troubling surrender to political ideology. Bishop Trimble's endorsement of legislative efforts like the so-called "Transgender Bill of Rights" reveals how deeply entangled the denomination has become with secular activism. The mission of the Church is not to function as a lobbying arm of any political movement. When ecclesiastical authority is used to advance controversial social policy, it risks replacing the Gospel with partisan talking points.

Fourth, there is the issue of truth itself. Christianity is not built on subjective identity but on objective reality grounded in God's creation. While compassion toward those struggling with identity is essential, compassion divorced from truth becomes cruelty. Affirming a path that may lead to lifelong medicalization, sterility, or regret--especially for minors--cannot simply be baptized as love. Love, in the Christian sense, seeks the good of the other, not merely the validation of their feelings.

Fifth, this development does not stand alone. It is part of a broader theological trajectory within the United Methodist Church that has already embraced abortion rights and same-sex marriage--positions that many traditional Christians believe contradict clear biblical teaching. Each step has been framed as progress, inclusion, or justice. Yet taken together, they reveal a pattern: the steady redefinition of sin, the erosion of scriptural authority, and the elevation of cultural approval over divine command.

What makes this moment particularly tragic is that it is happening under the banner of Christianity. The language of "justice," "care," and "human rights" is being used to justify practices that many believers see as fundamentally at odds with the faith once delivered to the saints. This is not merely a disagreement over policy--it is a dispute over the very nature of truth, the authority of Scripture, and the mission of the Church.

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In the end, the question is not whether the Church will be seen as compassionate by the world. The question is whether it will be found faithful by Christ.

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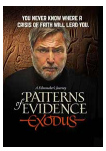

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